

ISA-SALES-FRAMEWORK

- ISA Sales Framework — Distress Psychology + Results Driven Methodology
 - The single most important idea in this document
 - Section 1 — The 8 Distress Psychological States (the foreclosure ICP map)
 - Section 2 — The Help-Frame Opener (replaces “are you considering selling”)
 - Section 3 — The Four Options (the menu Kareem always has)
 - Section 4 — TARP (every call, opened and closed)
 - Section 5 — UMBC (the qualification gate — replaces the 4 Pillars)
 - Section 6 — Non-Committal Language (interrupt every time)
 - Section 7 — Boxing Objections (exact order, never out of sequence)
 - Section 8 — Same-Side Selling (Kareem has no pricing authority, by design)
 - Section 9 — Silence Control (the non-negotiable)
 - Section 10 — The 10 Motivation Categories (RD standard — used for handoff notes)
 - Section 11 — Verify The No (mandatory — the rookie-killer)
 - Section 12 — Tonality Standards
 - Section 13 — Hard Flags (auto-fail — coaching review the same day)
 - See also

ISA Sales Framework — Distress Psychology + Results Driven Methodology

Audience: Kareem, Aaron (coaching), Danielle (handoff context). **Purpose:** The complete operating framework for every Kareem call. Replaces the 4 Pillars of Motivation gate. Anchored to the Wright Home Offer Results Driven (RD) methodology with a foreclosure-distress adaptation layered on top.

The single most important idea in this document

The bruise is already exposed. Don’t press on it. Acknowledge it.

The standard RD “bruise analogy” tells the rep to *press on the bruise to find pain* — that’s correct for general motivated-seller calls. For our ICP — homeowners in foreclosure, probate, and post-sheriff-sale redemption — **the bruise is already in plain view**. The court filed it. The newspaper printed it. The neighbors know. The prospect knows we know. Pressing on it again — “What’s got you thinking about selling?” — is what predators do.

Kareem's job is the opposite: **acknowledge the situation calmly and move directly to what can be done about it.** Help-frame, not interest-probe. The qualification emerges from the help conversation. We are never trying to extract a "yes I want to sell" from someone who is in shame, denial, or fatigue — we are offering a few real options and letting them tell us which one fits.

Section 1 — The 8 Distress Psychological States (the foreclosure ICP map)

Every foreclosure / probate / redemption homeowner is operating from one or more of these states when Kareem reaches them. Reading the state in the first 30 seconds determines the rest of the call.

1.1 Shame

What it sounds like: clipped answers, defensive tone, "I'm handling it," fast hangup attempts.

What's underneath: they feel like a failure. They haven't told family. They expect judgment. **How Kareem helps:** never reference the foreclosure as a failure. Reference it as **a situation thousands of Ohio homeowners face every year**, and the only thing that separates outcomes is whether someone helps them understand the options. Calm, low, slow tonality. Same-side language only.

1.2 Denial

What it sounds like: "The bank's working with me." "I'm doing a loan mod." "It's going to be fine." "The sale isn't going to happen." **What's underneath:** magical thinking. They've been in this state for months. Most of these "loan mods" are not progressing. They need an off-ramp without admitting the off-ramp. **How Kareem helps: never argue with denial.** Validate the bank conversation, then offer the **parallel-track frame**: "That's good — keep that going. Lots of people in your spot also keep a backup plan in their pocket in case the bank stalls. Can I share what those usually look like?" The backup-plan framing lets them keep their dignity and still hear the options.

1.3 Learned Helplessness

What it sounds like: flat tone, "It is what it is," "Whatever happens, happens," "Nothing I do matters." **What's underneath:** months or years of watching their situation get worse. They've stopped believing action changes outcomes. **How Kareem helps: smallest-possible-action framing.** Don't ask them to make a big decision. Ask them to spend 5 minutes hearing the four options, with explicit permission to do nothing afterward. Their nervous system is preserving energy — match it. Calm voice. No exclamation points in tone.

1.4 Suspicion-of-Vultures

What it sounds like: “Who is this?” “Where did you get my number?” “Are you a wholesaler?” “I’m not selling.” **What’s underneath:** they’ve been called 30+ times by predators, “we buy ugly houses” texts, sketchy mailers. Their pattern-match is “scam.” **How Kareem helps: disarm with transparency, not charm.** Public records → Wright Home Offer → local Ohio buyer → not a national company → not a wholesaler assigning contracts → references available. The longer Kareem stays calm and informational, the more the suspicion thaws. Never sell.

1.5 Decision Fatigue

What it sounds like: “I can’t deal with this right now.” “I just want it to go away.” Long sighs. Distracted answers. **What’s underneath:** they’ve been making hard calls for weeks — court, lawyers, family — and their bandwidth is gone. **How Kareem helps: reduce cognitive load to one decision.** “I’m not asking you to decide anything today. I’m offering you a 5-minute call where I lay out four options. You don’t have to pick one. You just have to know they exist.” TARP becomes load-bearing here.

1.6 Grief (probate-specific)

What it sounds like: longer silences, voice cracks, “We’re still figuring things out,” “It’s only been a few weeks.” **What’s underneath:** they’re dealing with loss while the legal system demands paperwork. They are not ready to discuss the property as a transaction. **How Kareem helps: back off, build trust, return when they’re ready.** Day 1 probate is not a sales call. It’s a “you have my number, no rush, here when you need it” call. Recycle for 30-60 days. The probate runway is 6-9 months — patience compounds.

1.7 Fear of Judgment

What it sounds like: lowered voice, “Don’t tell anyone,” asking about confidentiality, hesitant to share the property situation with family. **What’s underneath:** they don’t want neighbors, kids, parents, ex-spouse to know. They feel isolated. **How Kareem helps: explicit confidentiality.** “Everything we discuss stays between us — I’m not on social media about this, I don’t talk to your neighbors, I’m one Ohio buyer working a public-records lead. If we end up working together, the closing happens at a title company, not in your driveway.”

1.8 Magical Thinking / Hail Mary

What it sounds like: “My brother’s going to lend me the money.” “The lottery just hit.” “I’m waiting on a settlement.” “My job’s about to come back.” **What’s underneath:** they’re holding onto a low-probability rescue plan because the alternative is admitting the situation. **How Kareem helps: don’t kill the hope, parallel it.** “That’s great — I hope that comes through. While you wait, do you want to

have the backup option mapped out so you don't have to scramble if the timing slips?" The backup framing again.

Section 2 — The Help-Frame Opener (replaces “are you considering selling”)

Every Kareem call opens with help-framing. Never with interest-probing. The single sentence that signals everything:

“I’m a local buyer in [county] County. Based on where your situation is now, I usually have three or four options to share with folks in your spot — and not all of them require selling. Worth five minutes to walk through them?”

What this sentence does:

1. **Local Ohio buyer** — disarms the national-scammer pattern-match.
2. **Where your situation is now** — acknowledges the bruise without naming it harshly.
3. **Three or four options** — implies expertise. Predators offer one path: sell to me. Helpers offer a menu.
4. **Not all of them require selling** — kills the wholesaler frame in one clause. This is the line that opens the most doors.
5. **Five minutes** — TARP-compliant time anchor.
6. **Worth** — invitation, not demand.

Kareem’s tonality on this sentence is the test of whether the call goes anywhere. Calm, slow, warm, **not eager**. If he sounds like he wants something, the prospect’s nervous system flags it. If he sounds like he’s offering something, they lean in.

Section 3 — The Four Options (the menu Kareem always has)

For any distress lead, Kareem can credibly offer one of four paths. **He shares all four every time** because the option a homeowner picks is rarely the one Kareem expected.

#	Option	When it fits	What we do
1	Cash sale to Wright Home Offer	Owner wants speed + cash, no equity to fight for, ready to be done	Buy as-is, close 7-14 days, no agent fees, no inspection contingencies
2	Refer to a bankruptcy or foreclosure-defense attorney	Owner has equity + wants to keep the house + has income to support a workout	Free referral to a vetted Ohio attorney; we don't get paid; we win the long-term relationship
3	Refer to HUD-certified housing counselor	Owner is overwhelmed and wants free, neutral guidance from someone who isn't trying to buy	Free government-funded counseling; builds enormous trust
4	Just answer questions / explain the process	Owner is confused about what foreclosure actually means, what redemption is, what probate timelines look like	Free 5-10 min call. Kareem becomes the helpful expert. They remember us when they're ready.

Critical rule: Kareem only earns money from option 1. He shares all four anyway. **Sellers can tell when someone is offering an option they don't profit from.** That's how trust gets built in 90 seconds.

Section 4 — TARP (every call, opened and closed)

TARP is the #1 ghost preventer. Set it at the START and END of every call. Missing TARP is the most common cause of seller no-shows.

- **T — Time:** how long *this* call will take. "Five minutes."
- **A — Agenda:** exactly what gets covered. "I'll lay out the four options I usually see for folks in your situation."
- **R — Result:** the outcome of the call. "By the end you'll know which paths exist. You don't have to pick one."
- **P — Permission to say no:** "If none of them are the right fit, that's perfectly fine — you won't hurt my feelings."

TARP Alignment Rule: the TARP at the END of one call must MATCH the TARP at the BEGINNING of the next call. Same time promise, same agenda, same result commitment. A rep who says "I'll have Danielle call you Thursday at 2 — she'll spend 10 minutes asking about the property condition

and walking you through what we'd offer" must have Danielle open the Thursday call with that exact frame. Mismatched TARP = ghosting.

Section 5 — UMBC (the qualification gate — replaces the 4 Pillars)

Kareem captures four data points on every connect. UMBC stands for:

- **U — Urgency:** when do they need this resolved? Court-driven (sheriff sale, redemption deadline, probate calendar) and life-driven (relocation, health, family pressure) both count.
- **M — Motivation:** the **real** reason — pressed via Socratic follow-ups, never accepted at face value. Map to one of the 10 RD Motivation Categories (see Section 8).
- **B — Ballpark:** what they think the property is worth or what they'd want to walk away with. **Kareem has zero pricing authority** — he extracts the ballpark, never quotes one. The 3x3 rule applies: ask three different ways before flagging.
- **C — Condition:** quick livability check. Is anyone living there? Major issues? (Roof, foundation, plumbing, hoarding.) Full 14-point intake is Danielle's job, not Kareem's.

UMBC outcomes (one of four — every call lands here)

Outcome	When	What Kareem does
A — Qualified (U✓ M✓ B✓ C✓)	All four captured, motivation real, ballpark in our cash range, livable or fixable	Warm handoff to Danielle via REISimpli webform + group text on the team thread. TARP for Danielle's call. Confirm callback time 3 times .
B — Novation seed	Urgent + low-distress + ballpark ~90% of market + livable	Plant novation language ("there's a chance you might qualify for a special program where we list it on the MLS for top dollar — Danielle would walk you through it"). Hand off as novation candidate.
C — Listing pivot	Urgent + ballpark well over our cash range + livable + has time	Offer Aaron's licensed-Realtor pivot ("if you have 60-90 days, listing might net you more — happy to introduce you to Aaron, he's a licensed Ohio agent"). Note in REISimpli as "listing referral."
D — Not yet	One or more UMBC dimensions missing OR motivation isn't real OR they're in distress state #1.6 (grief) or #1.3 (helplessness)	Verify The No. Re-status, never kill. Schedule recycle by distress state — see ISA-CADENCE.md . Referral ask if a hard no.

Section 6 — Non-Committal Language (interrupt every time)

These phrases mean the prospect is not 100% committed. Proceeding past them = wasted handoff, wasted Danielle time, lost deal.

Red-flag phrases: "Sure." / "Let me think." / "I think I can do that." / "Maybe." / "I'll try." / "Probably." / "We'll see." / "More or less." / "Obviously, I would want to think, but..."

Quick Interrupt (light non-committal)

"You think you'll sell? I might be a little crazy, but it sounds like you may not be 100% certain you want to sell right now — and that's okay."

ALWAYS calm. ALWAYS label what they said. ALWAYS give them room to confirm or correct.

5-Step Non-Committal Recovery (if it persists)

1. **Pre-step Go For No:** “It seems to me you’re a little unsure about selling right now — that you’re exploring options but not ready to make a decision anytime soon.”
 2. **Acknowledge & Align:** “Totally get it — most of the people I talk to aren’t sure what they want to do yet. They just want to understand their options. Out of curiosity, what made you pick up today?”
 3. **Unlock Motivation Through Curiosity:** “If you did decide to sell, what would that allow you to do next?”
 4. **Remove Risk:** “This doesn’t lock you into anything — it just gives you information.”
 5. **Soft Close:** “So, would it make sense for us to spend a few minutes today walking through the property and talking through what numbers might look like?”
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Section 7 — Boxing Objections (exact order, never out of sequence)

When the seller gives a vague objection — “I need to think about it” / “I need to talk to my wife” / “Now’s not the time” — Kareem boxes the objection in this exact order:

“Okay, I can appreciate that. If you don’t mind, I’d like to ask a few quick follow-up questions. What exactly is it that you need to [think about / talk to ___ about]?”

1. **“Is it the idea of working with me? Did I do something wrong?”** — almost always elicits “no, no, you were great.” Eliminates Kareem as the objection.
2. **“Is it the process? Do you have any questions about the process?”** — if yes, answer them.
3. **“Is it the price?”** — almost always the real objection. (Kareem still doesn’t quote a price — he routes to “I get it, that’s why I’d want to get you on with Danielle who can fight for the right number with my partners.”)
4. **“Are you considering other options?”** — note: **“options,” never “offers.”** Saying “offers” plants a bidding mindset. Saying “options” surfaces realtors, family advisors, attorneys.

Vocabulary Lock

Kareem **never** uses these words: - “Other offers” → say “other options” - “My company” → say “my partners” (preserves no-pricing-authority leverage) - “I’ll give you” → say “what we typically see in this range” - “Buy your house” → say “find a path that works for your situation”

Section 8 — Same-Side Selling (Kareem has no pricing authority, by design)

Kareem is **never opposed to the seller**. He is on their side, working against a shared problem. Pricing decisions happen with “the partners” (Aaron, Danielle, the buy-box). Kareem’s job is to *fight* for the seller back to the partners. This is structural leverage.

Locked phrases

- “I want to take this back to my partners and fight for you.”
 - “I’m really trying to make this work for you.”
 - “I get it’s lower than you hoped. I really do want to go back and fight for that number. What number would you need to be at that you feel comfortable walking away with?”
 - “I’m worried that if I don’t have a number from you and I go back to my partners, they’re going to set the price — and I’m afraid the partners’ number won’t be one you like.”
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Section 9 — Silence Control (the non-negotiable)

Silence is a tool, not a problem. Kareem **does not fill silence** after:

- A calibrated question (“What would you walk away with?” / “What’s the plan if the bank stalls?”)
- An emotional label (“Sounds like this has been weighing on you.”)
- An empathy beat (“I know you wanted [X] — totally get it.”)
- A handoff TARP (after stating the time + agenda + result for Danielle’s call, **stop talking**)

Reps who fill silence with “and we can also cover closing costs, and we’re flexible on timing...” lose the negotiation every time.

Minimum silence after a calibrated question: 4 seconds. Real silences of 8-10 seconds are expected and welcome.

Section 10 — The 10 Motivation Categories (RD standard — used for handoff notes)

Every seller’s motivation falls into one or a blend of these. Capture the dominant category in the REISimpli handoff form.

Category	Pain Signal
Financial	Debt, mortgage stress, foreclosure
Emotional	Stress, anxiety, overwhelm, attachment to property
Relationship	Divorce, disputes, inheritance conflict, co-owner disagreement
Physical	Property disrepair, owner health, safety
Mental	Overwhelmed by complexity, indecision, fatigue
Time	Lack of time, conflicting priorities
Goal-Blocking	Property blocks other goals/opportunities
Extreme Pleasure (Rewards Missed)	Missing out on positive opportunities
Spiritual	Faith/values-based conflict
No Motivation	Indifference, resignation

Orientation: also flag **Away From Pain** vs **Toward Pleasure**. Almost every foreclosure ICP is Away From Pain — frame the relief, not the outcome.

Section 11 — Verify The No (mandatory — the rookie-killer)

Every “not interested” gets verified. No exceptions.

“Okay — so you’re not interested in a cash offer for the property?”

If still no:

“So what has changed?”

This single question flushes sellers who *were* considering it and just listed, sold, or had something change. Valuable intel either way.

If still no:

“Do you know someone who might be interested in a cash offer?”

If still no:

“That’s okay. I appreciate the time. If anything changes, my number is [number]. Take care.”

Re-status the lead. Never delete. Schedule the appropriate recycle (see [ISA-CADENCE.md](#)).

Section 12 — Tonality Standards

- **Calm.** Never rushed, never desperate, never needy.
 - **Curious, not combative.** Guide, not salesperson.
 - **Warm + authoritative.** The steady adult in the room.
 - **Never corporate.** Every phrase is scripted. None of them sound scripted.
 - **Same-side framing** in every sentence touching pricing or next steps.
 - **Empathetic, not sympathetic.** Label what they feel. Don’t drown them in “I’m sorry, I’m sorry.”
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Section 13 — Hard Flags (auto-fail — coaching review the same day)

Aaron audits a sample of Kareem’s calls weekly. These are auto-fail:

- Quoted a price, range, or hypothetical at any point
 - Substituted “other offers” for “other options”
 - Skipped Permission-to-say-no in TARP
 - Identified as a wholesaler or as part of a national company
 - Accepted “not interested” without Verify The No
 - Ended a call without one of: scheduled handoff + backup, verified no with referral ask, or pivot outcome (novation/listing/options-callback)
 - Argued with denial or pressed on the bruise
 - Ran past a non-committal phrase without interrupting
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See also

- [ISA-CALL-SCRIPTS.md](#) — preset-by-preset openers using this framework
- [ISA-QUALIFICATION-HANDOFF.md](#) — UMBC capture form + REISimpli webform
- [ISA-CADENCE.md](#) — when to recycle each distress state

- WHO OS Sales 02_departments/sales/scorecard.md — the Results Driven scorecard
Kareem will be graded against